

Nasif Salaam

Product Designer / AI Builder

hello@nasifsalaam.com · nasifsalaam.com · ai.nasifsalaam.com · +27 81 462 3628 · Cape Town

Product designer and AI builder with 15+ years across UI, UX, and AI-native product design. I design agent interfaces and model interaction flows, and I use AI design tools as a daily multiplier rather than a novelty, working directly in the IDE with Cursor and Claude Code rather than defaulting to Figma first. Recent work includes Kota AI, a multi-agent operations platform where I designed how agents receive context, use their tools, and hand results back to the interface, and RideNote, a mobile app I designed, built, and shipped solo to the App Store in 30 days. I care about making powerful AI systems feel simple to use, and I back that with an ISO/IEC 42001 Lead Auditor certification because responsible AI design matters as much as fast AI design.

Experience

Product Designer / AI Builder — Independent

2025 – Present · Cape Town (Remote)

Kota AI — Multi-agent operations platform for South African SMEs

- Designed the full system architecture before writing a line of code: two specialised agents coordinated by a router, each with its own context files, tools, and task definitions, so the interaction model between user and agents stays legible rather than a black box
- Built a knowledge base that agents query silently before every response, so business context is retrieved automatically instead of the user having to explain it every time, translating a technically complex retrieval system into a simple, invisible experience
- Designed a response contract where agents return typed JSON (table, document, list, chart, action) and the frontend renders the matching component, so the interface adapts to what the agent is actually saying instead of forcing every answer into one generic chat bubble (Generative UI)
- Wired full observability so every agent decision, tool call, and cost is traceable, giving developer-facing visibility into how the system actually behaves, not just what it outputs

RideNote — iOS/Android suspension tuning app

- Designed and built a mobile app for mountain bikers to track suspension settings, solo and end to end: product definition, UX, UI, brand, and full implementation, shipped in 30 days
- Separated two concepts that early users confused, a bike's baseline settings versus per-ride overrides, and validated the fix directly with beta testers before it shipped
- Runs a structured feedback loop with real users, iterating on the interface from what people actually get confused by rather than assumptions

Client and Community Work

- Deliver AI workshops and advisory sessions, helping teams understand how to work with AI systems responsibly and practically
 - Designed and built brand identities, marketing collateral, and full websites for multiple clients, managing each project end to end from brief to delivery
-

Lead Designer — Immersion Group

Jan 2022 – Dec 2024 · Remote

Rapid Prototyping — Client Delivery

- Old Mutual (2023) and ABSA (2024): designed and built functional prototypes with live data, auth, and API integration in 2-month sprints, using rapid prototyping to validate design decisions with real stakeholders before committing to a full build
- Used these projects to establish a rapid prototyping service offering inside the agency, turning weeks of speculative design work into testable prototypes with real data

Banking Suite — Financial Services Client

- Built and maintained a scalable design system across three product surfaces for a major SA bank: consumer mobile app, public-facing web, and secure back-office dashboard, from a single system of 50-100 components
- Coordinated a team of 3 designers on a back-office onboarding project, running working sessions and leading stakeholder presentations over 5 months

Internal Innovation

- Pitched and led a company-wide innovation programme, running a rotating cross-functional team over 12 months to upskill designers on Google's Design Sprint, low-code, and AI-assisted workflows
-

Senior Web Designer — Machete Creative

Jan 2019 – Jan 2022 · Cape Town

- Delivered brand identities, logos, stationery, and marketing collateral for clients including a multi-property real estate portfolio and major retail brands
 - Built responsive WordPress websites and digital assets: banners, mailers, and promotional materials
 - Worked closely with developers on handoff: Figma specs, component notes, and responsive behaviour documentation
-

Earlier background: Freelance brand and digital design work across travel, hospitality, events, FMCG, and service industries (2014-2018), and in-house graphic design for retail brands including Musica and Clicks (2009-2012). Fifteen-plus years of visual and brand design craft underpin the product and AI work above.

Skills

Area	Detail
AI-Assisted Build	Cursor, Claude Code, Claude API, AI-accelerated frontend development, generative UI, prompt engineering
AI Systems - AI Assisted	LangGraph, LangChain, multi-agent orchestration, RAG, vector search, MCP, tool calling, OpenRouter
Design	Visual design, UI/UX, brand identity, design systems, prototyping, Figma, Adobe CC, Affinity
Frontend - AI Assisted	React, TypeScript, Astro, Tailwind, React Native (Expo)
Backend - AI Assisted	FastAPI, Python, Supabase, PostgreSQL, RLS, Supabase Auth, SSE streaming
No-code / Low-code	FlutterFlow, Webflow, Framer, WordPress
Tools & Process	Git/GitHub, Railway, Netlify, Warp, PostHog, Sentry, Linear, Agile/Scrum
AI Governance	ISO/IEC 42001, ISO/IEC 27701 (in progress), AI risk assessment, responsible use frameworks

Certifications

Certification	Issuer	Year
ISO/IEC 42001:2023 Lead Auditor	Mastermind Assurance	2026
ISO/IEC 42001 Foundation	UKAS	2026
AI Security & Governance	Securiti	2025
AI Fluency	Anthropic	2025
Introduction to Generative AI	Google Cloud	2024

Industry Experience

Financial Services · Retail & Consumer · Property & Real Estate · Technology & SaaS · Travel & Hospitality · FMCG & Events · Compliance & Governance